Craftit AI — Competitive Landscape Analysis

Last updated: 2026-02-24

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Confirmed Competitors

1. Midjourney

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Best-in-class image generation (V6+), web editor with inpainting/variation/zoom, no native video generation, no canvas/design tools. Recently added web app (moved beyond Discord-only).
Pricing	Basic $10/mo (200 gens), Standard $30/mo (15 fast hrs), Pro $60/mo (30 fast hrs), Mega $120/mo (60 fast hrs). Annual discounts ~20%.
Target Audience	Creators, artists, designers. Leans pro-creative but attracts casuals due to quality.
UX Approach	Originally Discord-only (high friction). Web app now available but still prompt-heavy — powerful but not simple for beginners. No guided workflows.
Strengths	Industry-leading image aesthetics and consistency. Massive brand recognition. Strong community on Discord.
Weaknesses	No video generation at all. No design/canvas tools. No mobile app. Discord UX alienates non-technical users. No template system. Limited editing controls.
Community	Huge Discord community (~19M members). Showcase channels. No native in-app community feed.
Recent Direction	Launched web editor, exploring hardware (reportedly). Added image editing features. Still image-only.
Mobile	Web-based only, no native mobile app. Mobile browser experience is functional but not optimized.

Relevance to Craftit: Midjourney has no video and no canvas. Craftit can differentiate on the full image→video→design pipeline and simplicity.

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2. Runway

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Gen-4/Gen-4.5 video generation (text-to-video, image-to-video), Gen-4 image generation, video editing suite, Act-Two (performance capture), Veo integration, text-to-speech, audio generation, upscaling. Most complete pro video AI platform.
Pricing	Free (125 one-time credits), Standard $12/user/mo (625 credits/mo), Pro $28/user/mo (2,250 credits), Unlimited $76/user/mo (unlimited explore mode). Annual billing.
Target Audience	Professional filmmakers, video producers, creative agencies. Increasingly targeting prosumers.
UX Approach	Powerful but complex. Dashboard with multiple tools. Requires understanding of credits, model selection, parameters. Not beginner-friendly.
Strengths	Best-in-class video generation quality. Full video editing suite. Enterprise features. API available. Multi-model access (Gen-4, Veo). Performance capture is unique.
Weaknesses	Expensive for casual users. Complex UX. Credits burn fast on high-quality models. No design/canvas tools. No template system for non-video content. Steep learning curve.
Community	Discord community. No in-app social feed or sharing.
Recent Direction	Gen-4.5 launch, Aleph video editing, Act-Two performance capture, integrating third-party models (Veo). Pushing toward full filmmaking platform.
Mobile	No dedicated mobile app. Web only.

Relevance to Craftit: Runway is the pro video leader but leaves casual users behind. Craftit's simplicity-first approach and upcoming auto-mode video gen directly target Runway's complexity gap.

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3. Pika

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation (text-to-video, image-to-video), Pika Effects (lip sync, sound effects, modify region), scene extension. Focused purely on short video generation.
Pricing	Free tier available. Estimated Standard ~$8/mo, Pro ~$28/mo, Unlimited ~$58/mo (credit-based). Pricing page was JS-rendered and not fully captured.
Target Audience	Social media creators, casual users wanting fun video effects. Younger demographic.
UX Approach	Simple and playful. Clean interface. Low barrier to entry. Fun effects-driven approach.
Strengths	Very accessible UX. Fun viral effects (lip sync, Pika Effects). Good free tier. Mobile-friendly web. Strong social media presence.
Weaknesses	Video quality below Runway/Luma for cinematic content. No image generation standalone. No design tools. No canvas. Limited editing. No long video capability.
Community	Discord community. Social sharing built around effects going viral on TikTok/X.
Recent Direction	Pika 2.0/2.1 model improvements. Doubling down on viral effects and accessibility.

Dimension	Details
Mobile	Mobile-optimized web app. Likely has iOS app.

Relevance to Craftit: Pika is the closest competitor in the "simple video gen" space. Craftit needs to match Pika's simplicity while offering more (image gen, canvas, long video).

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4. Canva AI

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Full design suite (posters, presentations, social media, videos), AI image generation (Magic Media), AI video generation, text effects, background removal, Magic Eraser, Magic Expand, templates (millions), brand kits, collaboration.
Pricing	Free (limited AI features), Pro $13/mo/person (500 AI credits/mo), Teams $10/mo/person (500 credits/mo), Enterprise custom.
Target Audience	Everyone — businesses, marketers, students, casual users. The "design for everyone" platform.
UX Approach	Extremely simple. Template-first. Drag-and-drop. The gold standard for accessible design tools.
Strengths	Massive template library. Full design ecosystem. Brand kits. Collaboration. Print integration. Huge user base (170M+ MAU). AI features integrated into existing workflows. Trust and brand recognition.
Weaknesses	AI generation quality is mediocre compared to dedicated AI tools. Video AI is basic. Not an AI-first platform — AI is bolted on. Image generation is not competitive with Midjourney/DALL-E. No community showcase. AI feels like a feature, not the core.
Community	No creator community/social features. Template marketplace from designers.
Recent Direction	Heavy AI integration across all tools. Magic Studio. Acquiring AI capabilities. Pushing into enterprise and workplace.
Mobile	Excellent mobile app (iOS/Android). Full-featured.

Relevance to Craftit: Canva is the design canvas king but with weak AI generation. Craftit's upcoming canvas + superior AI generation could capture users who want Canva's ease but with AI-quality output. **This is Craftit's biggest strategic overlap and opportunity.**

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5. Adobe Firefly

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Image generation (text-to-image), generative fill, generative expand, text effects, style transfer, vector generation. Integrated into Photoshop/Illustrator/Premiere. Video generation (Firefly Video) recently added.
Pricing	Free plan (25 credits/mo), Premium $9.99/mo (2,000 credits), included in Creative Cloud plans. Firefly is often a gateway to the full Adobe ecosystem.
Target Audience	Professional designers, photographers, video editors already in Adobe ecosystem. Enterprise.

Dimension	Details
UX Approach	Web app is clean and simple. But full power requires Photoshop/Illustrator knowledge. Dual-track: simple web + powerful desktop integration.
Strengths	Commercially safe (trained on licensed content). Deep integration with industry-standard tools. Enterprise trust. Content Credentials for provenance. Professional-grade editing combined with AI.
Weaknesses	Image generation quality lags behind Midjourney/FLUX. Video generation is new and behind Runway/Pika. Conservative approach limits creative freedom. Expensive if you need full Creative Cloud. Not standalone enough.
Community	Adobe Behance (separate platform). No in-app community for Firefly specifically.
Recent Direction	Firefly Video model, deeper CC integration, Firefly Services API for enterprise, content credentials push.
Mobile	Adobe Express mobile app includes Firefly features. Photoshop mobile has some AI features.

Relevance to Craftit: Firefly targets pros in the Adobe ecosystem. Craftit can win users who want AI-quality output without needing Photoshop skills or a Creative Cloud subscription.

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6. Higgsfield AI

Dimension	Details
Core Features	AI video generation, image generation (Soul 2.0 photo model), Cinema Studio 2.0 (3D scene control, cinematic sequences), Vibe Motion (prompt→motion design videos), AI Influencer studio, character consistency, contests, integrated Kling 3.0 model, chat assistant.
Pricing	Likely freemium with credit-based tiers (pricing page didn't render full details). Runs contests with large prizes ($500K).
Target Audience	Content creators, social media influencers, AI art enthusiasts. Younger, trend-forward audience.
UX Approach	Feature-rich but approachable. Multiple specialized studios rather than one interface. Community-driven with contests.
Strengths	Unique Cinema Studio with 3D scene control. Integrates multiple AI models (including Kling). AI Influencer studio is differentiated. Large contest prizes drive engagement. Active community.
Weaknesses	Brand awareness much lower than Runway/Midjourney. Feature sprawl — many studios may confuse users. Quality dependent on third-party models. No design/canvas tools.
Community	Built-in community with contests, trending submissions, sharing. Strongest community features among video-gen competitors.
Recent Direction	Cinema Studio 2.0, Soul 2.0 photo model, Kling 3.0 integration, $500K contests. Aggressive growth through community engagement.
Mobile	Appears web-first. May have mobile optimization.

Relevance to Craftit: Higgsfield's community/contest model and multi-studio approach is worth studying. Their Cinema Studio is similar to Craftit's manual timeline. Craftit's auto-mode long video gen could leapfrog Cinema Studio's manual approach.

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7. Freepik

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Massive stock asset library (photos, vectors, icons, videos, PSD), AI image generation (Mystic, FLUX integration), AI video generation, mockup generator, design editor, presentation maker.
Pricing	Free (limited downloads), Essential ~$9/mo, Plus ~$15/mo, Premium ~$25/mo. Pricing gated behind Cloudflare (couldn't fetch exact current tiers).
Target Audience	Designers, marketers, small businesses needing stock assets + quick design.
UX Approach	Stock-library-first with AI as enhancement. Simple search→download workflow. AI tools are secondary features.
Strengths	Enormous asset library. Established brand in stock content. AI generation as complement to stock. Affordable. Good for everyday business design needs.
Weaknesses	AI generation is not best-in-class. Not an AI-first platform. Video generation basic. No dedicated community for AI creations. Design editor is simple but limited vs Canva.
Community	Contributor marketplace. No social/sharing community for AI creations.
Recent Direction	Adding AI across all asset types. Mystic AI model. FLUX integration. Moving from stock → AI-augmented design.
Mobile	Mobile apps available but primarily download-focused.

Relevance to Craftit: Freepik competes on stock+AI hybrid. Craftit is AI-first which is fundamentally different. Low direct threat but Freepik's affordable pricing and stock library create value for budget-conscious users Craftit should be aware of.

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8. OpenArt AI

Dimension	Details
Core Features	AI image generation (100+ models including FLUX, SDXL, Midjourney-style), AI video generation, consistent character creation, personalized model training, One-Click Story creation, audio models, workflows. Multi-model platform.
Pricing	Free (40 trial credits), Essential $7/mo (4,000 credits), Advanced $14.50/mo (12,000 credits), Infinite $28/mo (24,000 credits), Wonder $120/mo (106,000 credits). Team plan $17.50/seat/mo. 50% annual discounts.
Target Audience	AI art enthusiasts, creators who want model variety, hobbyists to semi-pros.
UX Approach	Model-picker approach — choose from 100+ models. Powerful but can be overwhelming. One-Click Story simplifies narrative creation.
Strengths	Massive model selection. Competitive pricing. Character consistency. Story creation feature. Good credit value. Team plans.
Weaknesses	Jack-of-all-trades, master of none. Quality depends on model choice (inconsistent experience). UI can be cluttered. Brand less known. No design/canvas tools.

Dimension	Details
Community	Has community features but less prominent than Midjourney's Discord.
Recent Direction	One-Click Story creation, consistent characters, expanding model library, audio generation. Moving toward narrative content creation.
Mobile	Web-based, mobile-responsive.

Relevance to Craftit: OpenArt's One-Click Story is similar to Craftit's planned auto-mode long video. OpenArt offers more models but less polish. Craftit should ensure its auto-mode story experience is dramatically simpler and more integrated (image→video→canvas pipeline).

Additional Competitors

9. Luma AI (Dream Machine)

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation (Ray3/Ray3.14 model — native 1080p, HDR), image generation (Photon model), video modification, extend, references, upscaling, reframing. API available.
Pricing	Free (limited, draft quality), Lite $7.99/mo (3,200 credits), Plus $23.99/mo (10,000 credits), Unlimited $75.99/mo (unlimited relaxed mode), Enterprise (contact).
Target Audience	Pro video creators, filmmakers, API developers.
UX Approach	Clean, focused interface. Model-centric. Technical users who understand resolution/HDR settings.
Strengths	Ray3 is top-tier for video quality. Native 1080p and HDR. Good API. Reasoning capabilities in video gen. Research-driven company.
Weaknesses	Expensive at high quality (HDR burns 4-8x credits). No design tools. No community features. No image design/canvas. Complex credit system.
Community	Minimal. Discord exists but not central to product.
Recent Direction	Ray3.14 (4x faster, 3x cheaper, native 1080p). Pushing toward professional/cinematic quality. HDR video generation is unique.
Mobile	iOS app available (Dream Machine).

10. Kling AI (Kuaishou)

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation (Kling 3.0), image generation, lip sync, motion brush. Chinese-developed, global expansion.
Pricing	Free tier generous. Pro plans from ~$8/mo. Aggressive pricing.
Target Audience	Global creators, especially strong in Asian markets.

Dimension	Details
UX Approach	Straightforward. Clean interface.
Strengths	Very competitive video quality (Kling 3.0). Aggressive pricing. Strong R&D backing from Kuaishou. Good motion quality.
Weaknesses	Brand trust outside Asia. Data privacy concerns. No design tools. Limited ecosystem.
Community	Growing, especially via platforms like Higgsfield that integrate it.
Recent Direction	Kling 3.0 public release. Expanding global access.
Mobile	Mobile apps available.

11. PixVerse

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation (V5.6 model), native audio generation (sound effects, music, dialogue), multi-shot storytelling, text-to-video, image-to-video, real-time interactive world engine (research).
Pricing	Freemium, credit-based. Affordable tiers.
Target Audience	Creators wanting quick, complete videos with audio.
UX Approach	Simple interface. Full-screen creation. One-click complete storytelling.
Strengths	Native audio generation is unique — videos come with sound. Multi-shot storytelling built in. Fast 1080p generation. Strong cost-performance.
Weaknesses	Less known brand. No design tools. Research-stage features (interactive world engine).
Community	Growing but small.
Recent Direction	V5.6 with audio-visual consistency. Real-time interactive world engine research. Auto multi-shot storytelling.
Mobile	Web-based, mobile responsive.

12. FLUX (Black Forest Labs)

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Image generation only (FLUX.1 Pro, Dev, Schnell). Text rendering excellence. Open-source models.
Pricing	Starter $6.90/mo (500 credits), Premium $9.90/mo (2,000 credits), Pro $27.90/mo (8,000 credits). Also available through many third-party platforms.
Target Audience	Developers, AI enthusiasts, users who want Midjourney-quality with open flexibility.
UX Approach	Simple web app. Also available via API and open-source.
Strengths	Excellent image quality. Best text rendering in images. Open-source (FLUX.1 Dev/Schnell). Available everywhere (ComfyUI, OpenArt, etc.). Affordable.

Dimension	Details
Weaknesses	Image only. No video. No design tools. Minimal own platform — most usage is through third parties.
Community	Open-source community. No social platform.
Recent Direction	FLUX 1.1 Pro improvements. Focus on quality and speed.
Mobile	Web only.

13. Leonardo AI

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Image generation (Phoenix model), real-time canvas, motion generation (image-to-video), texture generation for 3D, fine-tuned models, image editing.
Pricing	Free (150 tokens/day), Apprentice ~$10/mo (8,500 tokens), Artisan ~$24/mo (25,000 tokens), Maestro ~$48/mo (60,000 tokens).
Target Audience	Game developers, digital artists, content creators.
UX Approach	Feature-rich with real-time canvas. More technical than Canva but more visual than ComfyUI.
Strengths	Real-time canvas is powerful. Good model training. 3D texture generation is unique. Solid community. Good free tier.
Weaknesses	Spread across too many features. Video generation basic. Not design-focused. Can be overwhelming.
Community	Active community, shared creations.
Recent Direction	Phoenix model improvements, canvas upgrades, video features.
Mobile	iOS app available.

14. Ideogram

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Image generation with industry-best text rendering, canvas/editing features, style mixing.
Pricing	Free tier, Plus ~$8/mo, Pro ~$20/mo.
Target Audience	Designers needing text in images, marketers, social media creators.
UX Approach	Clean, simple. Good at specific use case (text in images).
Strengths	Best text-in-image rendering. Clean UX. Design-oriented features.
Weaknesses	Narrow focus. No video. Limited editing. Less model flexibility.
Community	Growing community gallery.
Recent Direction	Ideogram 3.0 with improved realism and canvas features.

Dimension	Details
Mobile	Web-based.

15. Haiper AI

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation, animation. Founded by ex-DeepMind researchers.
Pricing	Freemium. Affordable tiers.
Target Audience	Casual creators wanting simple video generation.
UX Approach	Very simple. Minimal interface.
Strengths	Simplicity. Free access. Research pedigree.
Weaknesses	Quality behind leaders. Limited features. Small team. No design tools.
Community	Small but growing.
Recent Direction	Haiper 2.0 model improvements.
Mobile	Web-based.

16. Vidu (Shengshu AI)

Dimension	Details
Core Features	Video generation (Chinese-developed), long video support, multi-subject consistency.
Pricing	Freemium with affordable tiers.
Target Audience	Chinese market primarily, expanding globally.
UX Approach	Clean, straightforward.
Strengths	Strong video quality. Long video support. Competitive with Kling.
Weaknesses	Limited global presence. Language barriers. No design tools.
Community	China-focused.
Recent Direction	Global expansion, quality improvements.
Mobile	Mobile apps in Chinese app stores.

Competitive Landscape Map

Simplicity vs Power Matrix

```
                    HIGH POWER
                        |
             Runway ────┼── Adobe Firefly
            Luma AI     |   (w/ Creative Cloud)
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                          |
            Higgsfield ───┼── Leonardo AI
              Kling AI    |
                          |
──────────────────────────┼──────────────────────────
SIMPLE                    |                    COMPLEX
                          |
      Pika ───────────────┼── OpenArt AI
    Haiper                |   FLUX
   PixVerse               |
                          |
Canva AI ─────────────────┼── Midjourney
(design power,            |   (prompt-heavy)
 simple UX)               |
                          |
                     LOW POWER
```

Audience Segmentation

```
CASUAL ◄──────────────────────────────────► PRO/BUSINESS

Casual:     Pika, Haiper, PixVerse
Prosumer:   Midjourney, OpenArt, Higgsfield, Leonardo, Ideogram
Pro:        Runway, Luma AI, Adobe Firefly
Business:   Canva AI, Adobe Firefly, Freepik
Enterprise: Runway, Adobe, Canva
```

Feature Coverage Matrix

Competitor	Image Gen	Video Gen	Design/Canvas	Long Video	Community	Mobile App	A Stor
Midjourney	★★★★★	×	×	×	★★★★	×	
Runway	★★★	★★★★★	×	×	★★	×	
Pika	×	★★★★	×	×	★★	★★★	
Canva AI	★★	★★	★★★★★	×	×	★★★★★	
Adobe Firefly	★★★	★★	★★★★ (via CC)	×	★★	★★★	
Higgsfield	★★★	★★★★	×	★★★	★★★★★	★★	
Freepik	★★★	★★	★★★	×	×	★★	
OpenArt	★★★★	★★★	×	×	★★★	★★	★
Luma AI	★★★	★★★★★	×	×	★	★★★★	
Kling AI	★★★	★★★★	×	×	★★	★★★	
PixVerse	×	★★★★	×	★★	★★	★★	★
Leonardo	★★★★	★★	★★★	×	★★★	★★★	
Craftit AI	★★★★	★★★★	★★★★ (soon)	★★★★ (soon)	★★★	?	★★ (s

Gap Analysis

Where Competitors Are Weak — Craftit's Opportunities

1. 🎯 The "Full Pipeline" Gap — BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY

No competitor offers: AI image gen → design canvas → short video → long video in one platform.

- Midjourney: image only
- Runway: video only (basic image)
- Canva: design + weak AI
- Pika: video only
- Adobe: requires multiple apps + subscriptions

Craftit opportunity: Be the first all-in-one AI-first creative platform. The upcoming canvas + auto-mode long video gen would be unique in the market.

2. 🎯 The "Simplicity + Quality" Gap

High-quality tools are complex. Simple tools produce mediocre quality.

- Runway/Luma: excellent quality, complex UX
- Pika/Haiper: simple UX, lower quality
- Canva: dead simple, weak AI

Craftit opportunity: Deliver Runway-quality output with Pika-level simplicity. The "even a kid can do it" positioning is currently unoccupied at high quality.

3. 🎯 The "Auto Long Video" Gap

Nobody has fully automated long-form video generation with editorial control.

- Runway: manual editing only
- Higgsfield Cinema Studio: manual 3D scene setup
- PixVerse: multi-shot but limited control
- OpenArt: One-Click Story is image-based stories, not video

Craftit opportunity: Auto-mode (idea → script → scenes → camera → storyboard → final video with edit-at-every-step) would be a genuine first-mover advantage.

4. 🎯 The "Design Canvas + AI Generation" Gap

Canva has the canvas but weak AI. AI tools have strong gen but no canvas.

- Canva: millions of templates, mediocre AI
- Midjourney/FLUX: great images, zero design tools
- No one combines powerful AI generation with a design canvas

Craftit opportunity: The upcoming canvas (image → posters, cards, invitations) fills exactly this gap. Combine Midjourney-quality generation with Canva-style design tools.

5. 🎯 The "Community + Creation" Gap

Community features are either separate (Discord) or shallow.

- Midjourney: community is Discord, separate from creation
- Higgsfield: best in-app community but complex tool
- Canva/Adobe: no community
- Most: community is an afterthought

Craftit opportunity: Tightly integrated community where creations flow naturally into sharing, inspiration, and remixing. The existing community feature is a strong foundation.

6. 🎯 The "Mobile-First AI Creation" Gap

Most AI tools are desktop-first or web-only.

- Runway: no mobile app
- Midjourney: no mobile app
- Luma: has iOS but limited
- Canva: best mobile but weak AI

Craftit opportunity: A killer mobile experience for AI content creation would be highly differentiated. Kids and casual users are mobile-first.

Key Takeaways

Strategic Positioning for Craftit AI

1. Own the "AI-first Canva" position

Canva is the nearest strategic analogy, but Craftit should be what Canva would be if rebuilt from scratch around AI. Don't compete on templates — compete on AI generation quality + design output flexibility.

2. The auto-mode long video is your moat

No competitor has automated idea→final video with granular editorial control. Ship this well and it becomes the defining feature that drives word-of-mouth. PixVerse and OpenArt are closest but neither has the full vision.

3. Simplicity is your brand, not just a feature

Position explicitly against Runway's complexity and Midjourney's prompt engineering. "No prompt engineering needed. No timeline editing required. Just describe what you want." Every feature should pass the "can a kid use this?" test.

4. Don't compete on model quality alone

Model quality is a moving target (new models every quarter). Compete on **workflow** — the full pipeline from idea to finished, shareable content. No one else does this.

5. Community is a growth engine, not a feature

Lean into community hard. Contests (like Higgsfield), remixing, templates created by users, trending creations. This creates a flywheel: creation → sharing → inspiration → more creation.

6. Pricing should undercut Runway and match Pika

The casual/prosumer market is price-sensitive. Target $8-15/mo for core plans. Generous free tier for growth. Don't go premium pricing until you have enterprise features.

7. Mobile-first is a blue ocean

If Craftit can deliver a genuinely excellent mobile creation experience, it would be nearly alone in the market at quality AI generation. This aligns perfectly with the "even a kid" mission.

8. Watch these competitors closest:

- **Canva AI** — if they improve their AI generation quality, they become the biggest threat (they have the UX, users, and canvas already)
- **Pika** — closest in simplicity + video gen positioning
- **PixVerse** — auto storytelling with native audio is innovative
- **Higgsfield** — community model and Cinema Studio overlap

9. Timing advantage

The canvas launch + auto-mode long video could create a "full platform" narrative that no competitor currently claims. Ship both in 2026 and own the "complete AI creative suite for everyone" position before Canva catches up on AI quality or Runway simplifies their UX.

Analysis based on publicly available information as of February 2026. Pricing and features change rapidly in this space — recommend quarterly updates.